

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

24 June 2021

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING:
RECORD OF DISCUSSION

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel Eric Charron
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Colonel Steve Sibbald (Retired)
Member / Serving Rep	Lieutenant-General Frances Allen (ABSENT / REGRETS)
Member / Serving Rep	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin
Member / Serving Rep	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Reserve Rep	Brigadier-General David Awalt
Member / Retired Rep	Brigadier-General William 'Bill' Richard (Retired)
Member / Honorary Rep	Colonel Ken Lloyd
Member / CO Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Bahir Ali
Member / Signaller's Club	Major Mike DeNoble (Retired)
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Blair Christie

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

- LCol Bahir Ali welcomed as incoming Commandant (and CO Museum / Home Station Cmdt).

REVIEW & APPROVAL OF PREVIOUS ROD

- Record of Discussion, dated Tuesday, 02 1500 Mar 21 APPROVED by the Branch Leader.

NETHERLANDS 2022 UPDATE

- LCol Hugh Janssen (Ret'd) is the lead organizer of this event.
- Current tally of attendees:
 - 35 x sponsored soldiers and aviators confirmed
 - 17 x individuals paying own way
 - 52 x in total as of this report
 - Possible another 10 x sponsored troops: MTF.
- Trip is scheduled for May 2022.
- Financial Summary:
 - Overall assessment is that the BF Study Tour (Netherlands) is in good shape
 - We have hotel credits and a reimbursed amount from the Merit travel agency
 - No more national fundraising needed
 - Managed to reduce the cost for each sponsored soldier from \$3,600.00 to \$2,500.00
 - End-Sept – \$500.00 per person is required as upfront payment.
- Safeguards (COVID / Cancellation):
 - Off-ramp I – September: May cancel / postpone another year+ (at which point we paid out no money) but will lose hotel credits.
 - Off-ramp II – January: May cancel prior to making final & full payment.
 - Off-ramp III – 7-days prior to launch: Merit Travel has option cancel for any reason. Requires each soldier to pay \$300.00 insurance (which recover \$75% of all expenses) up to 7-days prior to launch.
- Liesbeth Langford still plans to come to Holland and meet the tour. She currently lives in the UK with her husband, and are both in their mid-80s.
- Memorial Plaque presentation is planned between Dutch and Canadian Signals (Dutch Barracks).

- Potential visit from Princess Margariet – the Dutch equivalent to HRH, The Princess Royal, Princess Anne (Colonel-in-Chief of the C&E Branch). She may be invited to participate in the plaque presentation.
- Visiting Groesbeek and Holten cemeteries.

ACTION ITEM:

- **LCol Hugh Janssen**
Draft and submit a Briefing Note (BN) recommending GO / NO GO and commitment of efforts and funding prior to September 2021.

HRH VISIT 2023 UPDATE

- 24th of October 2023 = 120th of the RCCS / C&E Branch.
- HRH is aware of potential invites from conversation held in person in London, 2019 between HRH and the Col Cmdt.
- Aware of planning / event fatigue for major events due to BF Study Tour
- Current Plan: HCol Jim Lockyer (of the 8th Canadian Hussars) confirmed that the 8th CH is celebrating their 175th in 2023. They invited HRH to New Brunswick on May 24 to visit. 3-day plan for her. 8th CH is inviting all other Corps & Services to which HRH serves as Col-in-Chief.
- LCol Hunter (CO 8th CH) spoke to LCol Jeff Nelson (CO 37 Signal Regiment, NB).
- Leveraging 37 Sig Regt as our co-ord POC, we plan to send Branch Reps to NB (e.g. Gagetown, Sussex, Moncton, or Saint John, etc.) to host a small ceremony.
- Reps, location, and event details TBC.
- **INJECT:** The Signallers' Club has been involved in at least the last five reunions with two of them being chaired by a mbr of the Club. In 2018, the last reunion, the chair was the Col Cmdt and it was mainly run by the Branch Adjnt and his assistant. Five or six Club mbrs assisted in the organization of the weekend events. Our members are aging and will probably agree to assist again but only take a minor part in the organization in 2023. It would be impossible for the Club to solely conduct the Branch reunion. Retired mbrs have no authority on the base and as a result would be unable to do any bookings or sign any contracts. If the Branch decides to hold a reunion they should be planning it NOW. There is a full AAR from 2018 available with many suggestions from the Chairman and others who were involved. The normal dates are either the Labour Day Weekend or the weekend closest to the Branch birthday in Oct.

- Normally very few serving mbrs attend the Reunions and probably 75% who attend are from the Signallers Club. As a result, if the Branch does not hold a Reunion in 2023, the Sigs Club will probably just organize a gathering downtown for the club. If this is the case, the club will still require time to organize it. As a result, we are asking the C&E Branch to decide by 1 Jan 2022 if they will be organizing a branch reunion for 2023.

C&E FAMILY SURVEY

- 25 x Q&A generated based on Branch / Association / Foundation / Museum affairs.
- Survey Monkey was the elected platform.
- Bilingual issues postponed the release (+\$1,000.00 expense to unlock multilingual version)
- Google Forums, etc. researched as alternatives, but are not optimal for translation
- Initial plan was to release in June (shall be delayed)
- Researching options and timings
- BL acknowledged *survey fatigue*

BRANCH REPORT

- **OC Branch Heritage & Tradition:** No applicants received; REO competition shall be re-posted online every 14 calendar days until a suitable applicant applies.
- **Home Station Staff Officer (HSSO):** Applicant – 2Lt Simon Grant from BC – starts 12 July 2021. Class B Permanent position that is responsive to the Branch (C&E affairs), but responsible to the CFSCE Commandant (Home Station and Museum affairs).
- **Branch HR Manager:** Sergeant Isabelle Belanger (Class B Permanent) may depart for other career options as early as this APS. This will impair the Branch's ability to handle administrative affairs (event requests, travel, funds, TD, R&Q, etc.).
- **CMCEN:** Very successfully, thousands of visits per week, and is adversely impacting access times online due to queuing. Tech NCO – Sergeant Terry Cadieux – recommends upgrading from PRO to ENTERPRISE (\$50 – \$150.00 increase per year). Supported by Association.

ACTION ITEM:

- **Maj Blair Christie**
Upgrade to ENTERPRISE and balance Branch Funds accordingly.

MUSEUM REPORT

- Acknowledgement owed to Karen Young, whose expertise in Grant applications, DHH funding requests, CFB Kingston allotment (\$100,000.00 per year), and RCME allotment (\$35,000.00 per year) successfully reduced and balanced museum expenditures to a level where the Foundation does not have to dip into the principal endowment fund.
- Service Level Agreement (SLA): Agreement between PSP and BoD for HR / accountability / employment of NPP staff is ongoing. Liaison with Ben Ouellet to be conducted in September
- Re-opening museum (linked to conditions). Base Comd – from CDS thru Army Comd – decides. Currently planned for 25 September 2021.
- Joe Costello – Interested in joining Museum BoD. BoD Chair (Col Charron) plans to officially endorse and invite him.
- Next Museum BoD planned for September 2021.

ACTION ITEM:

- **LCol Bahir Ali**
Formalize and submit a SLA with Base Kingston to officially retain \$100K for the Museum.

INJECT – C&E WEEK 2021 PLANNING GUIDANCE

- Draft schedule is enclosed.
- Virtual themed.
- Plan to increase presence from last year and invite the main C&E Force Employers (FE): D Sigs, Strat A6, Comd CFIOG, CJOC J6, CANSOF J6, Comd 7 CG, and MPC P6 along with Command Team Partners
- Mess Dinner unconfirmed ... but unlikely.
- Branch Leader intends to wait out on formal submission until August DTG so as to better assess political appetite for increased in-person attendance and the COVID environment.

FOUNDATION REPORT

- **1st – Budget:** Karen Young's efforts on financial management and savings resulted in a final request to the Foundation that did not impact the endowment fund.
- **2nd – *Streamathon*:** successful, raised \$4,000.00 for 200+ hours of volunteer effort (lessons / actions on). Can use again.
- **3rd – Foundation Leadership Foundation:** Col Sibbald is resigning as Chair in October. As of this writing, no one is geared up to step in as a replacement. Col Sibbald is not optimistic about finding a replacement internally. Foundation is asking for a Branch-wide call out for (1) directors and (2) a Chairman / Chairwoman. The Branch Leader acknowledged that is no one is interested, then the Foundation may have, in fact, runs its course and that dissolution may be the mature option if we cannot find suitable leaders. This is not the preferred option as such a change would require a new approach to generate and control funds.
- **4th – Support to BF Study Tour:** Managing funds for this project is subject to heavy scrutiny from Revenue Canada and the Income Tax Act. It also requires a proper audit trail.
From BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe: As the Col Cmdt is directing the BF Tour through LCol Janssen, then the conclusion to be drawn is that the event is under C&E Branch jurisdiction. As the C&E Branch is a qualified donee, then monies generated for the event can be channelled to the Branch account to render payment as per the original BF Study Tour 2020 and Vimy Tour.

ASSOCIATION REPORT

- Activities of Interest:
 - **C&E Week PD Event** – Topics include (1) Remote Working, (2) Tours, and (3) Cyber. Reception is planned.
 - **CFS Clinton** – Sponsored a plaque to commemorate. VAC supporting. 19th September in Vanastra, Ontario is planned event. MTF in July.
 - **Bylaws Review** – exhaustive review & clean-up to align it with new legislation.
 - **Input to CMCEN version 4.0** – heavy volunteer effort is applauded.
- Issues / Concerns:
 - **Ongoing Roles / ToR for staff** – work continues.
 - **Volunteers and sustainment is an issue** – finding people to do jobs is difficult.
 - **Funding** – relied Symposium for revenue; we need to look elsewhere and expand options.
 - **Secretary** – CWO Michelle Boislard (former Branch CWO): facing health issues and wishes to bring this to the attention of the Senate.
- Bill Richard: Bravery Park in Orangeville event. BL was CO 2 Sigs and 2 Sigs shall be there. Col Cmdt and Branch Chief are going. 2 Sigs leadership shall be present as well.

C&E NCM COUNCIL

- **Point 1** – Member and Subaltern of the Year amendments (MoTY and SoTY). Reserves now submit their own entry for each competition. Captured in instructions and uploaded to CMCEN.
- **Point 2** – Educational Grant changes. Tired-level removed; now 5 x \$1,000.00 grants (2 for officers and 3 for NCMs). Captured in instructions and uploaded to CMCEN.
- **Point 3** – BF Tour. Discussed fund-raising, no issues mentioned.
- **Point 4** – Graduation Charges. Council recommends that the charge be left to commissioned officers as NCMs have a badging ceremony.
- **Point 5** – Wishes to set-up a recording of the Brach Adjutant's history & protocol lectures for posterity. MTF as this plan unfolds. May be able to leverage Pub Dev, CFSCE.
- **Point 6** – Discussed *Any C&E NCM Trade* succession planning positions. Noted that most tiered CWO appointments are owned by the Canadian Army and opened a discussion to review the merits of allowing for any C&E NCM to apply (e.g. SCWO CFSCE). Corps Chief warned that doing this may cause the Comd CA – who owns these positions – to expand beyond RCCS and open them to any Army MOSID.

- **Point 7** – Funeral SOPs / Aide Memoire needed (ranks, funds, TD, etc.). HSSO likely to take the lead on SOP development once the C&E Chiefs produce an initial plan. MTF.
- **Point 8** – Bandmaster and future of the Band. WO Gagnon retires in 2022. Creating a Class B position is not impossible, but very difficult. There is a potential replacement, but Class A not enticing and may result in no suitable replacements or any applications at all. Branch CWO continuing with discussions and options.

COLONEL COMMANDANT NOMINATION

- Nomination in for Ministerial approval for past 7-8 months. Parliament resumes in September, potential for an election. BGen O’Keefe shall remain on until replacement is confirmed.

OPEN FORUM

- NSTR.

CLOSING REMARKS

- NSTR.


Brigadier-General Kevin O’Keefe (Retired)
Colonel Commandant

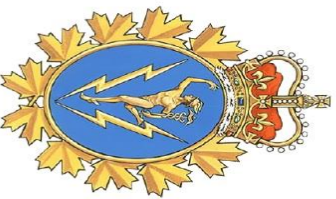
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Brigadier-General James Lambert
Branch Leader

Enclosure: 1 (C&E Week 2021 Master Schedule)

C&E Week 2021: Master Event Schedule

Sat, 23 Oct 21	Sun, 24 Oct 21	Mon, 25 Oct 21	Tue, 26 Oct 21	Wed, 27 Oct 21	Thu, 28 Oct 21
Opening Address MS Teams Museum 1300-1330	Reserve G6 Conference MS Teams NCR 0800-1600	Army G6 Conference MS Teams NCR 0800-1600	Army G6 Conference MS Teams NCR 0800-1600	Br Ltr CAF 16 Address MS Teams Museum 0845-0945 0945-1000	C&E Family Update MS Teams Museum 0900-1200
Reserve G6 Conference MS Teams NCR 1330-EOB	Carruthers Gravesite Cataquai Cemetery 1100-1200	RCAF A6 CAPCON MS Teams NCR 0800-1600	RCAF A6 CAPCON MS Teams NCR 0800-1600	PD Seminar MS Teams Museum 1000-1500	Senate Meeting MS Teams Museum 1300-1500
Honorary Colonel's Course MS Teams Museum 1500-2000		Indoc Course MS Teams CFSCE 1000-1530	Indoc Course MS Teams CFSCE 1000-1530	Association AGM MS Teams Museum 1515-1600	
		Exercise NOBLE SKYWAVE 21 EW: Net Control Station 0800-1600	Exercise NOBLE SKYWAVE 21 EW: Net Control Station 0800-1600		
		Meet & Greet Military/C&E Museum Timings TBC			

C&E Family Update Schedule	
Opening Remarks	0900 – 0904
Branch Leadership Address	0905 – 0914
RCCS Update	0915 – 0929
RCAF C&E Update	0930 – 0944
CFIOG Update	0945 – 0959
CIOC 16 Update	1000 – 1014
CANSOF 16 Update	1015 – 1029
Comd 7CG Update	1030 – 1044
H&A Announcements	1045 – 1059
C&E Association Update	1100 – 1109
C&E Foundation Update	1110 – 1119
Home Station Address	1120 – 1129
Q&A Panel	1130 – 1149
CAF 1of Address	1150 – 1154
Closing Remarks	1155 – 1200



Legend:	
Cataaqui Cemetery	See Annex B for detailed directions. FB Live will facilitate virtual attendance.
MCS Teams	Default application for the majority of C&E Week events. Members may download for free or use Defence O-365 (<i>ecrn</i>) account. If the latter, ensure camera and microphone properly function.
Military C&E Museum	C&E Museum - Small and large Conference Rooms; primary locations for OPs to host their events.
NCR	National Capital Region - where the Reserve G6, Army G6, and A6 CAPCON will be virtually hosted.
CFSCCE	Forde Building - Large Conference Room, location of the Indoc Course staff
Net Control Station	Exercise NOBLE SKYWAVE MCS - Building: VC 55 Room: 124 Street Address: 12 Satellite Road